

Private Worship Vol IV - 3

In the interpretation He is speaking of grace. Of course, you know that grace is based on something you could work a million years and still not earn.

When we speak of positional truths, the things He has given us, we are speaking of His unmeritable, non-earnable grace. He has purchased and provided something, and you are believing for it.

With the highest operations of grace, and in particular when there are giftings involved, such as the gift of faith, He takes the standing that Jesus gave you, takes grace, and drops it in your heart. Even without having the victory at that moment, all of a sudden you are operating out of a pending victory. It drops in your heart. You have it, and you know you do. So you can shout and have a good time because you know that something you did not deserve, did not merit, and could not earn was given to you.

I am recognizing that place more and more as time goes by.

One of the most unusual operations of it that I can remember is when we had that line where God said that those who wanted to get in this line could come. It was a grace line, and it had to do with getting into condition. That was just a little over a year ago. Did you know it was that long? How many remember that line?

I remember it very well because all of a sudden I stepped back from the line, and it fell on me. For a moment I did not know whether I was standing or falling. It came on me, and all of a sudden that grace took me to the other end of the line.

Until then, I understood it praying in the line and instructing you that you were trading your standing for His and your weaknesses for His strength. I could pray that, and I understood it as an operation of His compassion.

That compassion began to operate in me to a level I had never known when I broke into it through private worship and got touched by His love for a minute. Knowing how much He loved you, it was not hard for me to walk out and understand that He wanted to compensate for many of your weaknesses. There is grace available even in a prayer line when God can find what He needs.

All of a sudden, you trade your standing off for His, and you inherit that strength. You know that you know you have it. Things change. They change.

He took me to the other end of that line and deposited me in that place that says, "Done." From that day to this, the forty pounds that I shed, my legs were designed to carry forty more pounds, and everything about it I loved. I loved the walking.

First I tried to run. I shuffled most of the time and walked between poles and things. Now I have legs designed to carry fifty or sixty more pounds than I weigh. I feel like I am gliding up here.

I tried to understand what happened to me. I think I can understand addiction a little from the early days, but I never inhaled. I knew I was addicted a little because I lost count. I quit buying expensive pipes. I had one cow head made out of steer horn that I got in Japan, and I liked it.

Finally I would just buy a dollar-and-a-quarter pack of tobacco with a pipe in it because I threw so many out on the way home from church. I would throw it out the car window, and Monday at work I would run down to the store and buy another one.

I can understand addiction. There was something in me that was like addiction. It was almost like it craved. High emotions would come on me and good feelings, and even though my body hurt all over and I shuffled down the road, I still wanted to go.

Now I am understanding how that worked. When that grace line falls like that, He will take you and put you up in the victory. You are on the path to it, but you have all the strength and everything you need to walk through to it.

I said that to say this: this is what He has done with me for revival. I had to step up a notch in His love. In finding missing pieces and understanding the attributes of God, in particular the one He called love, which He said He is, something changed.

He is the other attributes too, like sovereignty. But the one we seem to be most interested in is the one He said He is: He said He is love.

I have looked toward God many times and said, "If You are love and You are all-powerful, why are You leaving that little child blind that we just prayed for? If You are sovereign, why did You leave him blind? If You are love and You really love us that much, where is the problem? Why do we not just get more?"

We can get up and talk a good fight, preach a good preach, and yell about all our rights, but most of the time we go home and do not know why we are not getting them.

This has been one of the most glorious things for somebody who has been in the ministry and walking in power for at least twenty-eight or twenty-nine years, because I broke out praying. When somebody tells you that God can take an old war horse and teach him something that turns the power up, you should listen.

Somebody asked me the difference between compassion and passion. Good question.

Paul had tremendous compassion for the lost. Compassion and doctrine motivated him. It was his call. But his passion was the Jews. When his fellow apostles and elders fell on his neck, kissed him, and wept sore, it was mostly because he said, "You probably will not see my face again."

That is what passion does. Passion is what causes a person to come alive and makes life worth living.

I have compassion for the lost, mostly. I have compassion for His Word at this point. I have passion for this city.

God is love. He does not have it; He is it. A lot of people say, "I could document a lot of things He has done that say He cannot be." But He is. Trust me when I say that if He were not love, He would not have done those things. You would not be who you are now, and you would be lost.

The reason anybody had the capacity to be lost is because in the original Son there was the capacity to be who you are: free, an individual son of God.

He has love all right. I am just beginning to understand what I cost Him. That does nothing but cause more of the love of God to activate itself inside of me.

He was love. He is love. He cannot love the apostle Paul any more than He loves a drunk who died drunk on a table but was shaken awake for a moment for somebody to have him repeat a prayer of salvation. There he goes into a wonderful place, amazed that he is there.

If it were by a price he could pay, he would not be there. You say, "Does God love Paul more?" No. He is love. He does not have a capacity to love one more than the other.

As you have heard me say many times, our reward is not based on His love for us. It is based on our love for Him. What Paul received in heaven, where he is reigning from, and everything that has happened to him from that day to this, which has been two thousand years, is because he loved Him. He loved Him.

What is the point of a reward if you have nothing to overcome?

The fullness of that love has been given to me, not without price. The Father judges no man. He has committed all judgment to the Son because every human being was judged in the Son, whether they gave their life to Him or not.

The fullness of Hitler was judged in the Son for him. It was not just spiritual death. Everything he was judged for, the fullness of love, was manifested in the judgment on Christ.

Do you dare question whether it is available?

Why am I talking this way? Most of you want your ministry. You want the equipment and power. Certainly. Do you want a shortcut on a shortcut? What do you think God's motivation is, His lack of love for you? You want a shortcut? Find out how to receive what He has already given you.

"The power?"

More than that. Find out how to receive more of what He has already given you all of. God is love. If I am not operating in very much of it, it is not because He did not give it. I cannot make Him love me more, so I have to go where I am loved. I am going to go from where I am to where He is.

Are you going to operate in His power? Are you kidding? When He gets me loving the sinner like He does, when He gets me loving the lost like He does, when He gets me loving the sick children in the mute and deaf home like He does, are you kidding? I think I am going to let Him love me.

Because He is love and He cannot love me any more, I think I am going to find out how to start receiving what He has already given.

What did He say in 1 Corinthians 12 and 13?

Covet earnestly the best gifts: and yet shew I unto you a more excellent way.

He should not really have been separated into chapter 13 there, because it continues:

Though I speak with the tongues of men and of angels, and have not charity, I am become as sounding brass, or a tinkling cymbal.

Everybody jumps on that and says, "You can pray in tongues all you want, and it will not do you any good if you are not walking in love." That is wrong.

What he was saying is that you can speak with tongues and be mean as a snake and hurt people, but what you cannot do is have a habitual, consistent prayer life in edification and stay that way.

When he said, "Covet earnestly the best gifts," the best gifts are the ones that equip your call, not mine. That is what you are supposed to be desiring from Him: what He has for you in your calling.

The word covet is strong. It is one of the Ten Commandments, "Thou shalt not covet." It speaks of a desire of the flesh that cannot be brought under check by anything but the new nature. But when he says, "Covet earnestly the best gifts," he switches it over to the other side. There is a place in the Spirit where you can desire what He has for you, and the equipping of it, beyond anything you can work for or hope for.

When he says, "I show you a more excellent way," to do what? To desire the best. He is love. I cannot get Him to love me anymore. If enough was manifested at the cross, what is my problem? The fullness of His love was manifested there. I cannot get Him to give me more, but I can receive what He has already given me.

Getting to know Him is the transition from God to God the Father. The Jews basically knew Him as God. There was the teaching of "our father Abraham," which spoke of the seed in whom all the nations of the earth would be blessed, which was Christ. But the Old Testament saints were spiritually dead, so God's fellowship with them was limited by that death nature.

I have told you the story about the bird and the cat. A little baby kitten was adopted by a bird. The bird would bring him worms and feed him and take care of him. When they grew up, the bird would sit on the fence, and the cat adopted by the human family would come out. The two would leave together, the cat to go hunt and the bird just to fellowship with him. It made Ripley's Believe It or Not because two natures like that cannot fellowship with each other. It was a phenomenon.

God's fellowship with the Old Testament saint was limited by their death nature. He had to atone with animal blood and restrict it with law.

This transition from knowing Him as God to knowing Him as God the Father, they could not have. Jesus spoke of it to the Samaritan woman when He said the hour now is when the true worshipers will worship the Father in spirit and in truth. That was a positional truth. "In spirit" meant finally worshiping out of a nature that had been made a partaker of His divine nature and put into a kind of fellowship with Him.

Later Paul talked about it:

Now that you have known God, or rather are known of God...

He corrected himself. Not just, "Watch Him part the Red Sea," but, "I am part of the family now." How can you turn again to the weak and beggarly elements, to observance of days and law, when you have been put into fellowship by a new nature?

I have His nature.

This transition from God to God the Father was important for me. I started as a holiness preacher, then I edified, operated in gifts, and later came to Tulsa.

In the beginning of the 1980s there was a lot of talk about preachers building burnout homes for other preachers, taking them in and recovering them. It was a noble venture. You do not hear about them so much anymore, but that was what everybody was raising money for and talking about.

When this transition began, I realized the only reason a preacher needs a burnout preacher's home is because he does not make the transition from God to God the Father.

We had better talk about this. I am not being restrained by law. I am not being atoned for by animal blood. I am not being kept at arm's length by God, who can only get so close because of the nature I used to have. I am known of Him now. I am known of Him.

It seems that when you start entering into this, He will keep having me prophesy it. In this transition of knowing and being known by God, I never felt in my whole walk with Him, when I had myself under law for this and under that, the kind of pleasure I feel now.

Even when I was born again, filled with the Holy Ghost, and had a lot of feeling with the baptism of the Holy Spirit, it still was not the same as the pleasure that I feel. I can only understand it as the pleasure of the Father when He has been able to teach me who He really is, and that He is not the atrocious creature everybody talks about. He is that love He is manifesting, and He will do the things He said.

I call these the outer limbs, limbs that do not support the weight of most who want to crawl out and eat the fruit. These are things about God that people live two lifetimes and do not get to know because the transition is never made.

I feel His pleasure tremendously. By the time God got my mouth able to come to His defense, from that day to this He has not left me alone. I continually slip over and hear myself prophesying in defense of His character, as if He is absolutely elated to get to tell you He is not the monster most people thought He was.

In this transition He taught me something the other day, and I was trying to get it over to you. I missed the mark by one peg.

He used an example of a man of God that all of us honor and have honored. I am not going to use his name. He was in his seventies when he died from two complications, both of which could kill you.

When I started prophesying in defense of God's character concerning money, He said, "The love of money is indeed the root of all evil." We do not know how much that statement encompasses. The Lord taught me that when people make it past almost everything else, during that last forty, thirty, twenty percent of just about the best God can have, if nothing else works, that usually does.

The medium of exchange is understood by every ten-year-old and every hundred-year-old. This ministry I am talking about did a tremendous work in the earth. He was a legend on the mission field. There were stacks of checks on his desk that went to different missionaries around the world. The man was a legend when it came to salvations, programs, and ways of reaching out to a city.

If that same man had gone bankrupt, had owed everybody in the city and country, and could not pay anybody, it would have brought reproach on the ministry worldwide. Every ten-year-old to hundred-year-old, whether born again or not, would understand that this man had failed God.

Yet when the love and compassion of God were manifested in Christ, it was manifested in the most horrendous way. Isaiah 53 says His visage was marred more than any man, and His form more than the sons of men. My form is what makes me a man when I stand before you. Yet His form was altered more than any man.

It was not only the beatings. It was when disease came on Him. You would not want to know what happened that day. His form was marred more than the sons of men. No one born or to be born was more altered or disfigured.

When He gave His standing to you, it had to be good. You will not run into anyone who was altered more than Him in the day of your disease. Whether I have attained to it or not, there is a place in Him that He has provided for me, and there is no disease on this planet or anywhere else that has the power to cancel out what God has told you to do. Age is irrelevant.

If I died tomorrow, I would come back and correct you if you said God took me with disease. Do not ever blame God for any of my failures. Failure does not mean something evil; it means I did not get all that He had for me.

We can shift this any way we want, and when we are done shuffling it, the card we draw will say the same thing: He loved me enough that He made provision. That is what it will say.

If bankruptcy had happened, the reproach would have been sky high because everybody understands the medium of exchange. But let a person slip away into the night from a disease, and almost nobody questions it.

Then I said, "Okay, You are trying to tell me something."

He said, "Son, it is that indifferent attitude toward something you have been redeemed from that keeps the hospitals full."

Who is going to challenge it when it takes somebody off the planet and everybody yawns and looks the other way like that is normal? It is not. That same indifferent attitude toward healing keeps people from pressing in and leaves them the same as they are, even though Jesus has already paid the price.

These are the outer limbs we are talking about, but they are necessary if we are going to see revival in the whole city.

Once again, the fullness of love for me was manifested when God laid my place on Him. In that moment He could love nothing anymore. I do not question it anymore. There are no accusations in my heart. I do not question it anymore.

At least I have found out that there is a connection of my nature with His. Just like you and I have found out, there is a part of me that can be nurtured, a reservoir with an unlimited capacity to receive more and more of the love of God. When it manifests itself, it manifests in compassion.

There is no limit to how much of His love my born-again spirit can pool, reservoir, and manifest in Christ Jesus to this world.

Can anybody tell me how to suspend your spirit in His presence?

What makes you think He does not have time for you now? He has all eternity waiting for you. Why would He not spend time with you in fellowship and rapport and love between your heart and His?

He who has ears to hear, hear. Many are walking in a dry and thirsty place, thirsting and desiring for the thirst to be quenched, only to be disappointed time after time.

Many search in the wrong places and drink what does not satisfy. But I say that when He has come, He will guide you into all truth. He shall receive of Mine and show it unto you.

Who can show My compassion to you spirit to spirit? Who can open the reservoirs of your spirit and pour out the fullness of all that I am, when I was manifested both for you and gave you My standing?

Most teach truth, but truth mixed with error. Most teach according to this life, and they teach much that avails not and only addresses the temporal. Who can teach you these things that have to do with the heart and the spirit? Where man leaves off, this is where I will step in, quench, and satisfy your longing for that which you know not what.

Many of you search only to fill the emptiness but do not know what you search for. Therefore know this and see what I see: you who enter in will first be quenched by My living water, and then the natural will become a great state of joy and victory for you.

I had determined to step out here, and then the prophetic flow came. It is My compassion manifested in you that will take the cross and the manifestation of His provision.

I am seeing a cliff, and the crowd comes to disease, old age, and everything else that causes them to go over the edge. Then they fall away into darkness. This is the second time I saw this vision. The first time was when I was prophesying that Sunday about trying to make darkness come in here so we could talk to it. He wanted you to take light out where the darkness was.

People are plummeting into the abyss, and the curse of the fall is on them in fullness: age, diseases, institutions, asylums. Right there they get crowded off the cliff and fall into the abyss by disease, old age, and catastrophes.

What makes you think that in the compassion of God He will not work the cross on them first, healing and delivering them and giving them an opportunity to see who I am, that they might be saved?

But not in the complacent place. Who is it through whom? Who will stand up with the passion of My servant Paul? Who will single-mindedly set their course with such conviction that I might work in you what is necessary for what is coming?

The cross will work down at the hospital, at the abyss. It will work in the deaf and mute schools.

For God so loved the world. Did He give Himself first, or did the world give themselves first? He so loved the world that He gave. This love belongs to the Godhead. It was manifested for you in Him when the penalty and punishment were laid on Him, when the fullness of love was manifested.

When you get just a little of it, He will meet you where the deaf children live. Do you think God is defending His character? Does it seem impossible? What if you were the one in the school? Who would you want on your side? Would it give you hope to hear somebody across town speaking like this?

Unless I am consumed by my own needs, the more He meets them, I can begin to think this way.

What you are saying seems impossible. Yes. But what will it hurt you to get to know Him? What will it hurt for you to get in there and start worshiping Him anyway?

How many remember the prophecy that said, "How do you know that cities fall somewhere in there, in the receiving of the fullness of His love?" I am starting to come back a little bit. I am just going to have to worship Him for a minute.

How many appreciate what He said? How about helping me out?